

PALAK JHA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Rising junior at BITS Pilani who has built and deployed ML/AI systems in prod, led product 0-1 in healthtech, closed INR 90L+ in sponsorship revenue, and contributed to open source. Spent the last year helping startups in their zero-to-one journey.

EDUCATION

Birla Institute of Technology and Science

BE in Manufacturing Engineering

Expected Jul 2028

EXPERIENCE

Volvo Group | Product and AI Intern

May 2026 – Present

- Architected and shipped a full-stack machine lifecycle intelligence platform (Django + FastAPI, ETL pipeline, session auth) tracking sales pipeline stages across 27,938+ events; reduced data fetch time from a full working day to under 5 seconds, adopted by 15+ active users.
- Built ML layer from zero: GradientBoosting stage duration models with 80% CI across PO to IR to SO to Invoice, cohort-based stall-risk scoring eliminating false positives from prior threshold logic, and forward-chain imputation for missing VIN stage dates; scoring 4,773 pending machines across High/Medium/Low risk tiers.
- Took a performance measurement and version benchmarking platform from proposal to MVP, measuring agent performance across 10+ metrics with probe-based backend separation and a version comparison dashboard; adopted by 6 developers, cut performance review time from 3-4 hours to 30 minutes.

Saathi AI (CEL Venture Studio, BITS Pilani) | Founding Product Lead

June 2025 – Aug 2025

- Owned product 0 to 1 as founding PM over 2 months; shipped Figma wireframes, pitch deck, and product thesis with a 5-member team for an elder-first WhatsApp health assistant for post-op care replacing a Phonebooth check-in system.
- Conducted 30+ discovery interviews across 3 segments and 10+ hospitals; findings shaped B2B distribution model and secured a soft pilot confirmation with Apollo Hospitals.

Conquest, BITS Pilani | Lead, Partnerships and Alliances

Jan 2025 – Present

Asia's Largest Non-Dilutive Student-Run Startup Accelerator

- Structured and closed INR 90L+ in sponsorship revenue by designing value-aligned partnership theses and negotiating cross-functional deliverables with Vodafone Idea, Google, WestBridge, and EarthOn Foundation.
- Closed 15+ partnerships with AWS, Freshworks, Auth0, and others providing legal, product design, strategy, and tooling resources (\$300k+ in AWS Credits, \$150k+ in Chargebee usage) for cohort startups.
- Guided a team of 3 to define AI and SaaS thesis via VC reports and industry calls; built evaluation pipeline for 3,000+ applications, selected top 23 ventures for 2025 cohort with Gruhas, IAN, and Wadhwani Foundation.

Centre for Entrepreneurial Leadership (CEL), BITS Pilani | Core Member

Jan 2025 – Present

- Automated scouting pipeline for Summer in a Startup, reducing onboarding time from 30 minutes to 2-3 minutes per company, scaling from under 30 to 100+ startups.
- Spearheaded Desert Hack 2026 with 500+ participants; co-hosted workshops with Sarvam AI for mentorship and hands-on AI tooling sessions.
- Organized Bedrock with 2,000+ participants; 2026 edition saw 500%+ increase in footfall and 200%+ increase in revenue across onboarded campus businesses.

PROJECTS

GreptimeDB (Open Source)

Apr 2026

- Proposed and merged PR into GreptimeDB (8.5k stars) adding gRPC-Web support using tonic-web, enabling browser/edge clients without proxy infrastructure. [Issue link](#)

rust2cython (Open Source)

Jun 2026

- Built a CLI tool that generates Cython .pxd/.pyx bindings and a complete build pipeline from idiomatic Rust source using AST-level parsing (syn); handles structs, Options, Results, and numpy memoryviews, eliminating manual FFI shim authoring for existing Cython codebases.

SKILLS

Soft Skills: Product Strategy, User Research, PRD Writing, Stakeholder Management, Cross-Functional Collaboration

Languages: Python, Rust, Cython, C

Frameworks/Data: FastAPI, Django, React, Vercel, PostgreSQL, pgvector, TimescaleDB, SQLite, pmdarima, ETL pipelines

AI/ML: ML, Time-Series Forecasting, Gradient Boosting, LangChain, NLP, Vector Search, Model Training & Inference